for free games, with *Nexuiz*, *Open Arena*, *Warsaw* and *Alien Arena* all based on it. *Warsaw* particularly, looks promising even on a low graphics system.

Racing games for Linux are nowhere close to anything like Flatout or Need For Speed, in terms of graphics, but TORCS (The Open Racing Car Simulator) and TuxRacer are games worth checking out. With Linux having a history of being for the technically-oriented, some of the best Linux games around are space combat or space simulators. These include `D2X-XL`, `Battlestar Galactica` and `Vegastrike`.

Multiplayer gaming for Linux also has its dedicated community. This ranges from the MMORPG *Battle For Wesnoth*, to the combat-rpg space shooter called *Vendetta*. *Flight Gear* is a highly technical and very accurate flight simulator for Linux.

One important aspect of getting games up and running properly is installing the drivers for your graphics card. Installing a Linux distro on a machine that has a graphic card might be sacrilegious to many, but it still can be done, and is not that difficult. NVIDIA has been supporting Linux drivers right from the beginning, with ATI joining in as little as four years ago.

By and large, NVIDIA works better than ATI on Linux systems. You can download drivers for NVIDIA graphic cards from **http://www.nvidia.com/Download** (select the right operating system). On the other hand, drivers for ATI can be downloaded from **http://ati.amd.com/support/driver.html.** NVIDIA also offers drivers for FreeBSD and Solaris.

9.1 Using Wine to play windows games

Wine is the best solution to get Windows applications to work on Linux. Wine has been around for more than 15 years, and can handle a lot of applications seamlessly. However, many applications don't work as well as they would have on Windows, and many of the newer games in particular may face problems. Wine (which stands for Wine Is Not an Emulator) also maintains a library called WineLib, which software developers are increasingly adhering to. This simply means that a software developed for Windows will work on Linux through Wine with almost zero additional effort on the part of programmers.

Now what Wine does is add a processing layer between the operating system (Linux) and the Windows application. This